



BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCE, PILANI

INSTRUCTION DIVISION

FIRST SEMESTER 2025-2026

Course Handout (Part II)

Date: 03/08/2026

In addition to part-I (General Handout for all courses appended to the timetable) this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

Course No. : HSS F 227
Course Title : Cross Cultural Skills
Instructor-in- Charge : PUSHP LATA
Team of Instructors : Pradeep Bailwal (RS)

Scope and objective of the course:

1. Providing insights into intercultural communication with powerful and deeply held views from multiple cultures.
2. Familiarizing the students how to undertake that critical self-reflection which may lead to better appreciation of the cultural diversity possessed by communities worldwide.
3. Bringing into the discussions, the experiences of intercultural communication, knowledge of the field of communication studies and mass communication, and perceptions of intercultural communication as a woman and as men from diverse ethnic, racial and cultural backgrounds.
4. Using AI to enhance cross-cultural understanding, communication, and adaptation through interactive learning and real-world simulations.

Learning Outcomes

After doing this course the students will be able to:

1. Understand cross-cultural communication and its different dimensions based on national cultures, as propounded by Geert Hofstede and Edward T. Hall, as well as comparative study of various theories developed later, by researchers like Trompenaars & Hampden-Turner.
2. Gain a comprehensive understanding of how and why cultural groups differ and the nuances of cross-cultural teams.
3. Develop sensitivity to cultural variations in thinking, feeling, and behaving and adapting the same for cross-cultural communication effectiveness.
4. Learn management and interpersonal skills to reckon, predict, and leverage cultural differences.
5. Develop an appreciation for the global mindset vis-à-vis Indian cultural identity.
6. Know more about diverse national cultures and countries from class projects and presentations.





2 Text Book

- (i) Madhavan, Shobhana, 2016, Cross Cultural Management, 2nd Edition, New Delhi: Oxford University Press.

3 Reference Books:

- (ii) Jackson, Jane. Introducing language and intercultural communication. Routledge, 2019.
(iii) Bennett, M. (2013). Basic concepts of intercultural communication: Paradigms, principles, and practices. Hachette UK.
(iv) Patel, Fay, Mingshen Li and Prahalad Sooknawan, 2011, Intercultural Communication, Sage Publication New Delhi India Pvt. Ltd.
(v) Maude, Barry, 2011, Managing Cross-Cultural Communication: Principles and Practice, Palgrave Macmillan.

4 Course Plan: Lectures

LECT . NO.	MODULES	REF./T O TEXT CHAP.	LEARNING OUTCOMES
1	Introduction Class	-	Understand the course and learning expectations from the course
2	Overview of Intercultural Communication	1	Understanding what intercultural communication is, the basic concepts, issues and other perspectives Video: 1. <u>Cross-cultural communication Pellegrino Riccardi</u>
3	Classroom Activity	TBA	Know thy culture (using AI to understand cultures)
4-7	Theories of Cultural Dimensions – I	2	Understand different theories of cultural dimensions, comparing and contrasting theories and their application in real-life scenarios 4: Culture Model by E. Hall 5-7: Cultural Dimensions Theory by G.Hofstede and Culture Model by F. Trompenaars 1. <u>Halls classification of cultures</u> 2. <u>Hofstede's 6D Model of National Culture - Simplest Explanation Ever:</u>





8-9	Theories of Cultural Dimensions - II	2	Understand different theories of cultural dimensions, comparing and contrasting theories and their application in real-life scenarios 8-9: GLOBE Project 3. <u>GLOBE Project</u>
10	CAGE Framework		Understand the CAGE Framework and apply it to analyze cultural, administrative, geographic, and economic differences in cross-cultural contexts.
11	Classroom Evaluative	TBA	Offline Quiz
12-13	Body Language and Etiquette, across Cultures		Verbal vs non-verbal communication - greetings, gestures, proxemics, and eye contact; Etiquette – gifting, exchange of visiting cards, etc. 5. <u>Learn a new culture Julien S. Bourrelle</u>
14-16	Critical Issue in Intercultural Communication: Practice Challenges and Barriers	9 and 10	Understanding some critical issues in intercultural communication and strategies to communicate effectively. Reference to the conceptual frameworks and provide examples from real life situations 6. <u>Humor and culture in international business Chris Smit</u> 7. <u>Intercultural Miscommunication Exercise</u>
17	Cross-Cultural Blunders		Discuss the blunders in cross-cultural communication because of misinterpretation and mistranslation of verbal and nonverbal cues. Blogs: Cross Culture Blunders Lack of cross cultural awareness can cost a business big
18	AI to understand cross cultural Communication		Using AI to Understand Cross-Cultural Etiquette, Communication Barriers, and Responsible Cultural Adaptation
19-21	Classroom Evaluative	TBA	Vision Board: Knowing the other cultures
22-27	Intercultural Transition - International Adaptation and Cultural Shock	Reading material*	Understand the cultural adaptation process: 22 – 23: Acculturation 24: Cultural Shock 25: Reverse Cultural Shock 26 – 27: Developing Cultural Sensitivity
28	Classroom Activity	TBA	Know the Other
29-33	Understanding Cultural Influences in Marketing	5	Understanding the importance of culture in Marketing; the influence of history, geography and politics on culture and marketing. Applying the knowledge while doing market research by following 4 Ps of Marketing, namely product, place, price and promotion.





34	Classroom Evaluative	TBA	Case Study
35-38	Managing Global Team	8	Understanding the influence of culture on team development by knowing task strategies and process strategies of group work. Know the challenges of culturally diversified team with special focus on virtual teams. Apply the knowledge to create effective teams. 8. Managing Cross Cultural Remote Teams Ricardo Fernandez Blog: How culture and communication impact global teams
39-42	Classroom Evaluative	TBA	Quiz 2

Reading Material*: (Jack and Jane – Unit 8; Benett – Unit 4)

5. Evaluation Scheme:

S.No.	Components	Duration	Date & Time	Weightage	Nature of Component
1	Mid Sem	90 mts.	10/10 FN1	25%	CB
2.	Classroom Discussion and Evaluatives	To be announced	Class hour/ take home	35%	OB/ CB
3.	Attendance			05%	
4.	Comprehensive	3 hrs.	15/12 FN	35%	OB/ CB

6. **Make-up policy:** Make-up- subject to prior permission.

7. **Chamber Consultation Hour:** **Monday 9th hour**

8. **Closed Book Test:** No reference material of any kind will be permitted inside the exam hall.

9. **Open Book Exam:** Use of any printed/written reference material (books and notebooks) will be permitted inside the examination hall. Loose sheets of paper will not be permitted. No exchange of material will be allowed.

10. **Notices:** Notices, if any, concerning the course will be displayed on Nalanda / the Notice Board of HSS Dept.

Instructor-in-charge
HSS F 227



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